State of California in the trial as “political evidence.” Other key evidence focused on particular books she had read and may have shared with defendant Jonathan Jackson.

Leading up to and during her trial, the National United Committee to Free Angela Davis and others turned to Davis’s own words and circulated their own literature to contextualize her case around social divisions and networks of solidarity. This included copies of her “Lectures on Liberation” from UCLA, a radio interview aired on Gil Noble’s program in 1970 that was circulated and released by Folkways Records titled *Angela Davis Speaks*, and the pamphlet titled *A Political Biography of Angela Davis*, circulated in 1971, which would later be included in her widely read coedited volume, *If They Come in the Morning*.[42] As she sought to define herself and the movement around her, in such texts and others that would circulate, Davis and her colleagues began analyzing walls and social borderlines around her alongside other treatments of boundaries enforcing segregation, detention, and division. Her reach and solidarity networks grew, as she embraced a variety of rhetorical and narrative approaches.

For example, in Davis’s first two lectures from UCLA in 1969, in “Lectures on Liberation,” she demonstrates an attention to the traditions of critical approaches to boundaries. Prepared as a pamphlet by 1971, they were sold at 50 cents apiece, with the proceeds going toward her defense. Both lectures focused on Frederick Douglass’s autobiography, *The Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass, an American Slave, Written by Himself*. Davis’s supporters frame her case as a continuation of both her struggles at UCLA and a larger history of the African American freedom struggle and abolition of slavery as demonstrated through canonical literature. This is bolstered by a letter that opens the pamphlet, written and signed by twenty-nine supporting UCLA faculty. Davis begins her lecture by citing philosophical traditions of two distinct locales: ancient Greece and antebellum America. She examines liberation as a broader theme of struggle and examines enslavement as the direct opposition to freedom.

In these lectures Davis also frames Douglass’s status as a fugitive from bondage within a system of unjust laws, which merits resistance through flight to established modes of law and order. Douglass, she contends, goes on a journey of escape that encompasses his enslavement through his flight and onward to his abolition work. As Davis states, “The history of Black literature provides, in my opinion, a much more illuminating account of the